> China seeks to displace the United States in the Indo-Pacific region, expand the reaches of its state-driven economic model, and reorder the region in its favor. . . . China gathers and exploits data on an unrivalled scale and spreads features of its authoritarian system, including corruption and the use of surveillance. It is building the most capable and well-funded military in the world, after our own. Its nuclear arsenal is growing and diversifying.[2]

The report continues, "China is using economic inducements and penalties, influence operations and implied military threats to persuade other states to heed its political and security agenda." Vice President Mike Pence used similar language in his October 2018 speech to the Hudson Institute, adding that Beijing was also "employing a whole-of-government approach, using political, economic, and military tools, as well as propaganda, to advance its influence and benefit its interests in the United States."[3]

The question is: Can the United States counter this Chinese challenge without—as Henry Kissinger, Graham Allison, and others have warned—unwittingly falling into the "Thucydides Trap," which tends to bring an incumbent power into costly, violent conflict with a rising power?[4] Few scholars are better qualified to address that question than Michael Auslin. The eight essays brought together here illustrate the breadth and depth of his Asian expertise.

Unlike some specialists, Auslin is a fox, not a hedgehog: to follow the distinction drawn by the Greek poet Archilochus, he knows not just one thing, but many. The subjects under discussion in this volume range from the safety of North Korea's nuclear arsenal to the persistent impediments to gender equality in India. Auslin started his career as a student of Japan, and there is much of interest here about that unique country, a country that can seem to foreigners (as he nicely puts it) "of the world but perhaps not fully in it." (This comes from a brilliant essay, "Japan's Eightfold Fence," which is as good an introduction to modern Japan as I have ever read.) However, the main focus of *Asia's New Geopolitics* is, as it should be, the challenge posed by China to the